

Scholarships in Italy and France

What Pakistani students can actually apply for — and what they cannot.

Last checked September 2026. Requirements change — confirm against the consulate before you rely on any figure here.

DSU	Income	Separate	Early
the one worth your time	not grades, in Italy	from your university form	deadlines come first

Pakistan is not on the eligible-country list for the Italian Government (MAECI) scholarship for 2026/2027. Several Pakistani consultancy sites still advertise it. Check the official list at esteri.it before anyone charges you to apply.

Italy — DSU regional scholarship

- Assessed on family income, not on grades alone. This is why it suits Pakistani families.
- Awarded by the region, not the university, so rules differ between Lombardy, Emilia-Romagna, Lazio and the rest.
- Can cover tuition exemption, a maintenance grant, subsidised housing and meals together.
- Applied for separately from your university application, usually with an earlier deadline.
- Needs income and family documents translated and legalised — start before results arrive.

France — Eiffel Excellence

- You cannot apply directly. Your university nominates you.
- So the real deadline is the university's internal one, months before the official date.
- Master's and PhD only.
- Ask every institution you apply to whether they nominate, and by when, in your first email.

University and regional awards

- Most Italian and French public universities run their own fee waivers and merit awards.
- Smaller sums, far less competition, and very few Pakistani applicants apply for them.
- Listed on the university's own international pages, rarely on aggregator sites.

Getting it right

1 Shortlist on funding, not ranking

A funded place at a good public university beats an unfunded one at a famous one.

2 Write down three dates per university

Admission deadline, scholarship deadline, nomination deadline. They are rarely the same.

3 Prepare income documents early

Translation and legalisation take weeks and are the usual cause of a missed deadline.

4 Apply for the small ones too

Two or three modest awards often add up to more than one big one you did not win.

Want us to check your file before you book?

We work with Pakistani students applying to Italy and France. The first consultation is free, wherever you are in Pakistan.

www.vlstudy.online